



Tips & Tricks



Add extra swap space quickly

Check your used swap space using the following command:

```
free -m
```

or:

```
cat /proc/swaps
```

If the system has very little swap space, you can add more swap easily. Take the following steps:

- 1) Create a file that is of 1 GB size:

```
dd if=/dev/zero of=/dev/myswap bs=1024 count=1024000
```

- 2) Enable this file as swap space:

```
mkswap /dev/myswap  
swapon /dev/myswap
```

This will create an additional swap space of 1 GB. You can see the new swap added as:

```
# swapon -s
```

Filename	Type	Size	Used	Priority
/dev/sda6	partition	1020088	0	-1
/myswap	file	1016	0	-2

Append the following entry to `/etc/fstab` to make this swap permanent:

```
/dev/myswap swap swap defaults 0 0
```

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Terminal magic

Suppose you have to run many applications on a terminal (say, on the GNOME terminal) and you want to automate this process, you can use the command-line options of the GNOME terminal. For example:

```
$ gnome-terminal --geometry=80x20+700+0 --title=ping -x ping google.com &
```

...where:

- `geometry` will decide what the length and width of your terminal will be, as well as its position.
- `title` sets the title of the terminal.
- `-x` is for the command to run.
- `&` to run this as a background process.

See the man pages of the GNOME terminal for more options. You can set tabs and many more options by consulting the man pages.

Now, assume we want to run the following applications, viz.:

- 1) my server—let's say the name is `/home/xyz/myServer`
- 2) `tail -f /var/log/messages` to monitor the logs
- 3) `ping google.com`
- 4) SSH to some remote machine—for instance `xxx.yyy.zzz.aaa`

So I will make a script called `automate.sh` with the following information:

```
#cat automate.sh
```

```
gnome-terminal --geometry=80x20+0+0 --title=myServer -x ./home/xyz/myServer &  
gnome-terminal --geometry=80x20+0+400 --title=logMessages -x tail -f /var/log/messages &  
gnome-terminal --geometry=80x20+700+400 --title=ping -x ping google.com &  
gnome-terminal --geometry=80x20+700+0 --title=remoteMachine -x ssh root@xxx.yyy.zzz.aaa &
```